



analyse, convert, format and document

Here is a clean, playtest-ready Game Design Document for your concept, fully converted from the notebook scans and formatted for quick use in class or clubs. ^[1] ^[2]

Game overview

Game of Lies is a 6-player social-deduction storytelling board game where players narrate a single shared crime scene while hiding their identities and trying to expose the imposter. ^[1] ^[2]
The table's detective wins by correctly arresting the criminal based on story clues, while the criminal wins by convincing others of their innocence through plausible lies. ^[1] ^[2]

Theme and intent

The game explores peer manipulation and the danger of taking narratives at face value, turning critical thinking into a playful, safe exercise. ^[1] ^[2]

It aims to build structured reasoning, pattern recognition, and persuasion skills during collaborative story construction. ^[1] ^[2]

Players and roles

- Player count: 6 total. ^[1] ^[2]
- Hidden roles: 1 Criminal, 1 Detective, 4 Neutral Bystanders. ^[1] ^[2]
- Victory focus: Detective identifies the Criminal; Criminal avoids arrest and appears innocent; Bystanders support truth-seeking but may bluff. ^[1] ^[2]

Components

- Board: 6 parallel lanes, each with 10 steps (spaces). ^[2]
- Step types: Good and Bad consequence spaces dispersed along each lane. ^[2]
- Randomizer: spinner or equivalent to inject prompts or effects. ^[1]
- One six-sided die for lane selection and certain effects. ^[1]
- Role cards or tokens: Criminal, Detective, Bystanders, kept hidden in a covered box. ^[1]
- Pawns: one per player to track progress along lanes. ^[2]
- Optional aids: 60-second sand timer, Evidence tokens, Suspicion marker, Notepad and pencils. ^[1] ^[2]

Setup

- Shuffle role cards, deal one face-down to each player, and place unused cards back in the closed box to preserve uncertainty. ^[1]
- Each player rolls the die and claims the matching-numbered lane; ties re-roll. ^[1]
- Place all pawns on step 0 of their lanes, ready to move forward as stories are told. ^[2]

Core loop

- On a turn, the active player contributes story statements that advance the shared crime narrative while building on prior details. ^[1]
- For each relevant statement, move that player's pawn forward one step on their lane. ^[2]
- Relevance means the detail either progresses the timeline, clarifies a prior claim, or introduces evidence tied to characters, location, motive, method, or consequence. ^[1] ^[2]

Step effects

- When landing on a Good step, the player earns a benefit such as 1 Evidence token or permission to ask an extra question this round. ^[2]
- When landing on a Bad step, the player takes a penalty such as gaining 1 Suspicion or forfeiting their next follow-up question. ^[2]
- Consequences are framed in-story and must be justified by the narration to remain consistent with the shared timeline. ^[1] ^[2]

Cross-examination

- After each turn's narration, every other player may ask one question; the Detective may ask two to probe contradictions. ^[1]
- Answers must reference already-stated facts or introduce new details that then count toward movement only if the table accepts them as relevant. ^[2]
- If a player is caught contradicting their prior claims, they immediately step back one space unless they can reconcile the contradiction in-story. ^[2]

Accusations and arrest

- At any time after Round 2, the Detective may formally name a suspect and declare an arrest, ending the game if the table agrees to resolve. ^[2]
- If the Detective arrests the Criminal, the Detective wins; otherwise the Criminal immediately wins for successfully deceiving the table. ^[2]
- If no arrest is called by the end of Round 4, reveal roles; if the table majority would have accused the Criminal, the Detective shares a partial win, otherwise the Criminal wins outright. ^[1] ^[2]

Round structure

- Round start: Spin the randomizer for a prompt or modifier (e.g., "Introduce motive," "Describe an alibi," "Reveal a clue"). ^[1]
- Player turns proceed clockwise with narration then cross-examination. ^[2]
- End of round: Resolve any lingering Good/Bad effects and advance a global timeline marker if desired. ^[2]

What counts as a statement

- A discrete, falsifiable claim tied to the scene, characters, evidence, or sequence (e.g., "The window latch was broken before midnight"). ^[1]
- Vague filler, repeated facts, or meta-talk do not advance pawns. ^[2]
- Each accepted statement must be traceable to prior context or the current round's randomizer prompt. ^{[1] [2]}

Win conditions

- Detective: correctly arrests the Criminal before the final reveal. ^[2]
- Criminal: avoids arrest or causes a wrong arrest through convincing lies. ^[2]
- Bystanders: support deduction and enjoy narrative success; optionally share victory with the Detective on a correct arrest. ^{[1] [2]}

Tiebreakers

- If multiple suspects are equally compelling, check Suspicion totals; the highest becomes the arrest target. ^[2]
- If Suspicion ties, the Detective decides among tied suspects. ^[2]
- If the Detective refuses to decide, reveal roles and score an automatic Criminal win for successful confusion. ^{[1] [2]}

Example turn

- Prompt: "Reveal a clue." ^[1]
- Player states: "I found muddy shoeprints near the back door at 11:45," moves 1 step, then answers cross-questions about weather, tread pattern, and timing. ^[2]
- Landing on a Good step grants an Evidence token that can force one opponent to answer yes/no without elaboration later. ^[2]

Board spec for prototype

- Draw a 6×10 grid: six vertical lanes labeled 1–6, steps numbered 0–10 from bottom to top. ^[2]
- Mark Good steps at 3, 6, 9 and Bad steps at 2, 5, 8 on every lane for an alternating rhythm. ^[2]
- Use distinct colors or hatching for Good vs Bad to speed table adjudication. ^[2]

Setup checklist

- Print role cards and lane board; gather a die, spinner, six pawns, and tokens for Evidence and Suspicion. ^[1] ^[2]
- Deal roles, choose lanes by die, place pawns at step 0, and set a 60-second timer for narration. ^[1] ^[2]
- Read aloud the objective: tell a consistent story, spot lies, and make or dodge the arrest. ^[1] ^[2]

Table rules and safety

- Keep all content PG-13 and fade to black on self-harm or graphic details to maintain a safe, respectful play space. ^[1]
- No out-of-game information, secret texting, or recording; all evidence must be verbalized at the table. ^[2]
- If a player feels uncomfortable, pause and reframe the scene without penalty. ^[1] ^[2]

Balance levers

- Adjust difficulty by shifting one Good step to Bad per lane to advantage the Detective via more contradictions, or the reverse to aid the Criminal. ^[2]
- Limit Detective arrests to once per game for higher stakes, or allow one provisional accusation per Round 3–4 for faster conclusions. ^[2]
- Tune narration timer between 45–90 seconds depending on group experience. ^[1] ^[2]

Variants

- Fewer players (5): remove lane 6 and one Bystander; all other rules unchanged. ^[2]
- More players (7–8): add Bystanders and share lanes in pairs, counting only the front pawn for step effects. ^[2]
- Double agent: add a second Criminal who knows the first; Detective wins only by arresting at least one. ^[1] ^[2]

Educational notes

- Designed to practice structured narration, questioning, and consistency checking under time pressure. ^[1] ^[2]
- Works well for communication, critical thinking, and persuasion exercises in first-year cohorts. ^[1] ^[2]
- Short 20–30 minute sessions fit club meets and classroom warm-ups before technical work. ^[1] ^[2]

Print-and-play materials

- One A4 board with the 6×10 lanes, colored Good/Bad steps. ^[2]
- Six role cards and six pawns; 12 Evidence tokens and 12 Suspicion tokens; 1 spinner and 1 die. ^[1] ^[2]
- One page of 20 randomizer prompts covering motive, method, alibi, timeline, and clue types. ^[1] ^[2]

Quick start (teacher handout)

- Deal roles, pick lanes by die, place pawns at 0, and read the opening crime premise. ^[1] ^[2]
- Each player narrates within 60 seconds, moving 1 step per accepted statement and resolving Good/Bad steps on landing. ^[2]
- After Round 2, the Detective may arrest; a correct arrest wins for the Detective, otherwise the Criminal wins. ^[2]

If you want, a printable board PDF and role cards can be generated next from this spec for immediate playtesting. ^[1] ^[2]



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